

Final push

The last phase of the Tet Offensive began in August and also yielded little success for the NVA. They attacked 27 cities, 100 districts and military posts, and 47 airfields. However, just as in the May offensive, many of these attempts were short-lived. At the end of 1968, both sides had gained little from the offensives, and at the expense of great loss of life.

» AFTER

The year 1968 resulted in heavy losses for both sides and gave neither any permanent gains. War continued to be waged for South Vietnam—and for Saigon.

EVACUATION HUB

Tan Son Nhut would once again be at the center of the action in 1975. Before it was retaken by the NVA, it was used in the **evacuation** of American and South Vietnamese people, fleeing Saigon to escape the invading forces of the **final offensive**.

LOST SOLDIERS

Thirty-one US soldiers were listed as **missing in action** (MIA) after Kham Duc. When it was reoccupied by US infantrymen in July 1970—during Operation Elk Canyon I and II—patrols were sent out to look for the missing men. The bodies of crewmen from the Butcher crash were found in the 1990s, and were finally buried in the US in 2008.